

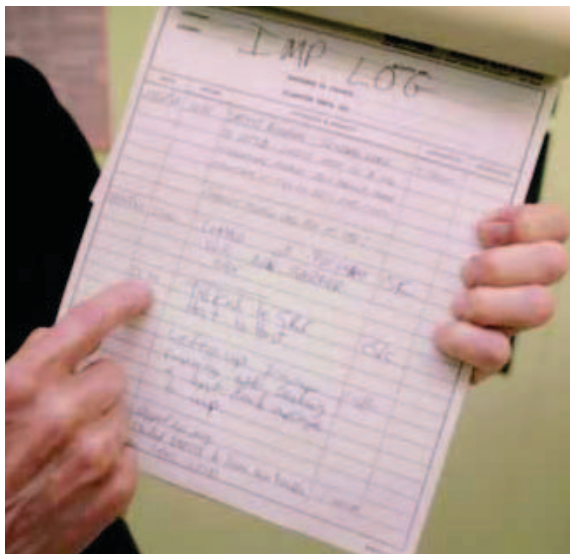


Figure 1: ARPANET IMP log (Source: Lo and Behold, Reveries of the Connected World, Magnolia Pictures)

The ARPANET was decommissioned in 1990, giving rise to the modern TCP/IP standards. As we can see, every written record has a story to tell.

Let us go back to another well-known story of 13th century BCE — the Trojan War. The Greek army failed to enter the city of Troy because of its high walls. So, they left a wooden horse outside the city and pretended to leave. The people of Troy brought the horse inside, and the Greek soldier hiding in it opened the city's gates. This led to the downfall of Troy in spite of the high walls protecting it. This was recorded and written much later. Trojan Horse is the computer malware that gets its name from this historic event.

Coming to today's world, everything is digitalized. And all digital activities leave a footprint in the form of logs. These logs tell a very vivid story, and it is very important to be able to read the story.

For example, we have a set of logs for just after a computer's boot sequence, as shown in Figure 2.

The computer is secured with the McAfee antivirus and security system. So, malware may not be able to affect it. However, every piece of log has a story to tell. Let us see this story from an attacker's point of view.

As an attacker, we can see that the DHCP client completed the handshake at 07:07:59. This means the computer is successfully online from 07:07:59. The WLAN-AutoConfig action to configure the Wi-Fi took place at 07:08:00. But the McAfee Service Controller started at 07:08:03. This means the attacker has a three second window to attack the system when it boots up.

[illegible]

Figure 2: Computer boot logs

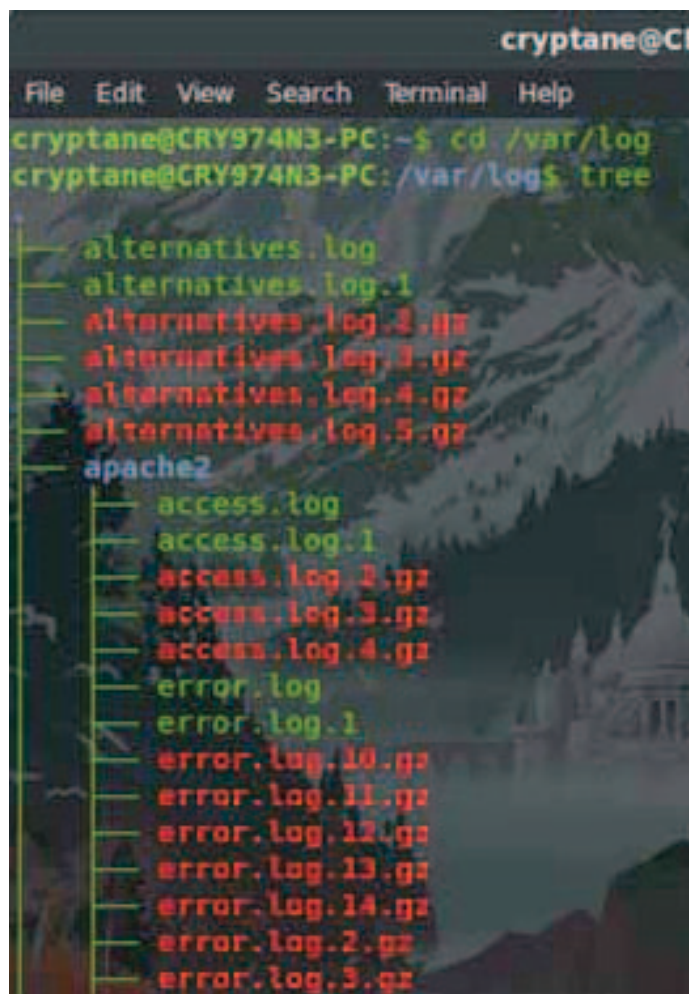


Figure 3: Linux logs